	7.16. CONTROL OF TECHNICAL RECORDS	
	Document no: ASMF7.16	
Compiled by:	Sifiso Nyambi - Laboratory Manager	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

Clause reference: ISO 17034:2016 – Clause 7.16 and ISO 17043:2023 – Clause 7.5

Applies to: All records and procedures generated in the production, testing, release, and post-distribution of Proficiency Testing samples and reference materials (RMs and CRMs)

The CAB has implemented a comprehensive document and record control system that governs both **internally generated documents** (e.g., SOPs, forms, quality procedures) and **externally sourced documents** (e.g., ISO standards, reference methods, and normative documents).
Top Management has full access and control over the entire Quality Management System (QMS), including the authorization, approval, and review of controlled documents. Personnel have restricted access—limited to the sections of the QMS necessary for performing their daily tasks. To safeguard integrity, all digital documents are password-protected and access-controlled to prevent unauthorized alteration.

All controlled documents, records, and associated data are maintained to ensure authenticity, completeness, traceability, and ease of retrieval. The system ensures that obsolete documents are promptly removed from points of use and archived with clear “Obsolete” markings to avoid unintended application.

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1. Purpose

To ensure that all procedures, quality and technical records are:

- Authenticated, complete and traceable.
- Easily retrievable for external and internal review.
- Retained for a defined period
- Protected from alteration, damage, or unauthorised access.

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07/2025	00	07/2028

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2. References

- ISO/IEC 17025:2017 Clause 7.5.
- ISO 9001: Document and record control guidance
- Internal SOPs for document handling

3. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Laboratory Manager	Ensure compliance with document control procedures, ensure records are complete and accurate
Laboratory Supervisor	Ensure that documents are filled out and signed (where necessary)
Lab Technician and/or Operator	Fill out records legibly, accurately and in real-time

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4. Scope of Records to be controlled

- Production Records: E.g. Processing logs, weighing sheets
- Characterisation data: e.g. Raw data, statistical calculations, assigned values
- Stability and homogeneity: Regression outputs
- Traceability: CRM usage, balances and calibration records
- Uncertainty budget: Worksheets, formulas, sources,
- Certificate of Analysis and labels: Version-controlled and final copies
- Training and Competence: Staff training matrix, authorisations
- Equipment logs: Calibrations, verifications, repairs
- Customer communications: Inquiries, complaints, feedback and follow-ups
- Review and approvals: Signature records, approval checklists
- Standard operating procedures
- Externally sourced documents(ISO standards)

5. Record Format and Identification

All records must:

- Clearly be titled and dated
- Include unique identifier (batch, project, or file number)
- Be linked to the PT & RM production plan
- Include signatures of responsible personnel
- Indicate version number (where applicable)

6. Storage and Access Control

- Paper: Locked in cabinets and in limited-access areas
- Digital: Password-protected folders, backup to secure servers
- Cloud-based: Must be encrypted, with restricted user roles
- Backup frequency- Quarterly
- Archiving of physical technical records are to be done at the end of each year, retrievable, and disposed of in line with contractual/legislative requirements.

7. Retention Period

- PT & CRM Production Data: At least 10 years after expiry date
- Calibration/Equipment logs: 5-10 Years
- Complaints and recalls : 3 Years
- Training and competence: Duration of employment +5 years
- CoAs: >10 Years

8. Amendments and corrections to records

- No erasures, strike through incorrect data with a single line
- Add initials, date, and the reason for the correction.
- For digital records, maintain audit trails.

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9. Quality Checkpoints

The below controls collectively ensure compliance with ISO/IEC 17025:2017 Clause 8.3.1, ISO 17034:2016 Clause 7.16, and ISO 17043:2023 Clause 7.5.

All document control measures are designed to preserve data integrity, maintain traceability, and prevent unauthorized modification of QMS documents or technical records including, but not limited to:

- Quarterly audits of record completeness and legibility
- Cross-links during CRM release, production records vs CoA
- Backup verification during management review
- Version control audits for CoA and label templates

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